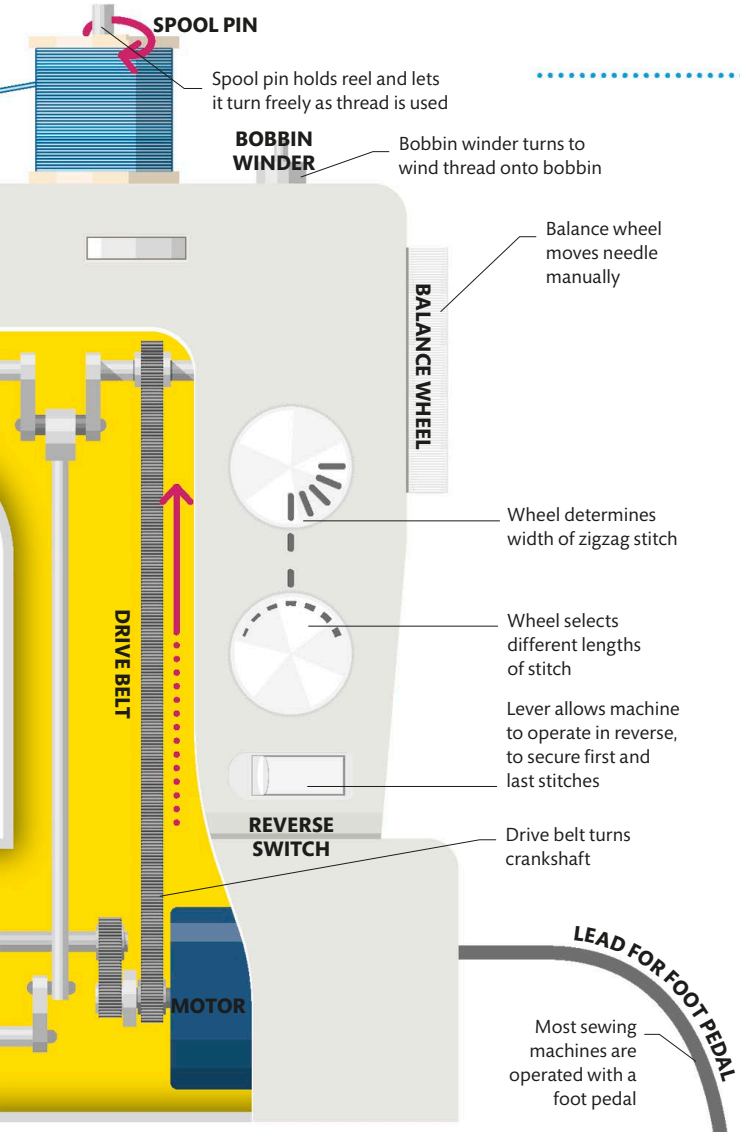
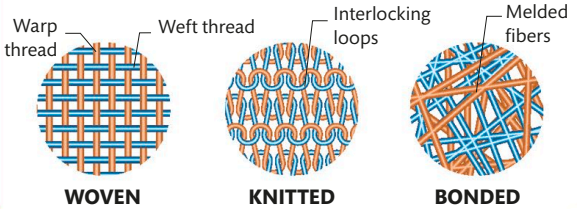


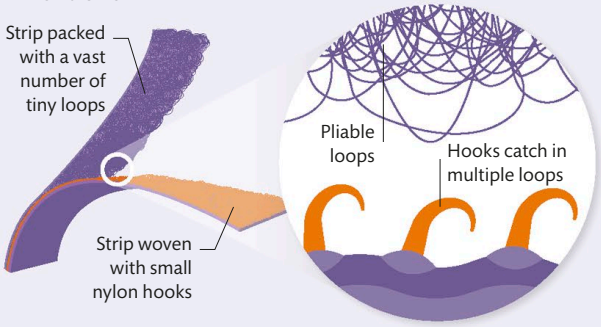
HOW FABRICS ARE MADE

Fabric is produced in a number of different ways. Woven fabrics are made from fibers or yarn interlaced at right angles. Knitted fabrics are made by looping long pieces of yarn together. Bonded fabrics are often made from webs of fibers melded together by heat, adhesives, or pressure.

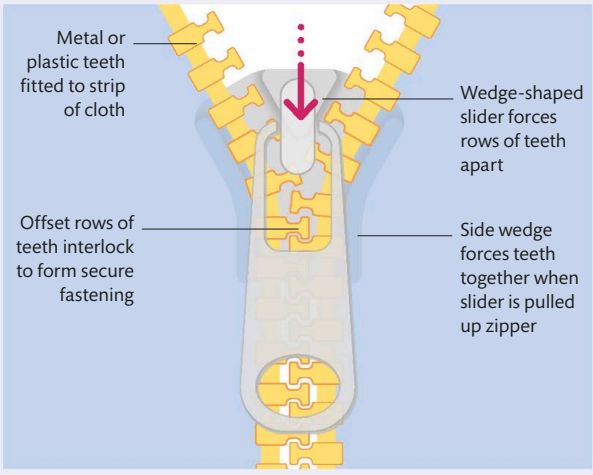


Fasteners

Clothing can be fastened in many ways from pop snappers to sewn-in magnets. Some fasteners, such as buttons, laces, and hooks and eyes, have been used for centuries. Others, such as the modern zipper and Velcro, are more recent inventions.



Velcro
This fabric fastener is modeled on the tiny hooks of some seed burrs that stick stubbornly to fur and fabric. Velcro consists of two strips of nylon or polyester—one containing large numbers of tiny loops and the other with hooks that engage with the loops to provide a secure fastening.



Zippers
These ingenious fasteners feature two rows of staggered teeth. The Y-shaped channel inside the slider eases the teeth together when it is pulled up the zipper. Unzipping sees the central part of the slider act as a wedge, forcing itself between the two rows and prying the teeth apart.

THE WORLD'S LARGEST ZIPPER PRODUCER MAKES OVER 7 BILLION ZIPPERS EACH YEAR